

HOW TO RUN PROJECT

NexHire - Group Alpha

Fast, accurate setup guide for cloning, configuring, running and logging into the final main-branch system.

Repository	https://github.com/Kogulanathan69/SmartRecruitmentMatching-2026-
Branch to use	main
Frontend / Login	http://localhost:5119/
Framework	.NET 8 (net8.0)
Database	SQL Server LocalDB - NexHireDb

IMPORTANT: There are no fixed pre-seeded login credentials in the repository. Job Seekers and Employers create their own account. Registration requires an email OTP, so SMTP credentials must be configured before testing a brand-new account.

1. Required Software

- Git for Windows (needed if cloning from GitHub).
- Visual Studio 2022 with "ASP.NET and web development" workload OR a terminal with the .NET SDK.
- .NET 8 SDK. A newer SDK may also build net8.0, but .NET 8 is the project target.
- SQL Server Express LocalDB / MSSQLLocalDB.
- Internet connection for first NuGet restore and for Gmail OTP delivery.

2. Clone the Final Project

```
cd C:\SharpProjects
git clone https://github.com/Kogulanathan69/SmartRecruitmentMatching-2026-.git
cd SmartRecruitmentMatching-2026-
git branch --show-current
```

Expected branch: main

3. Restore and Build

```
dotnet restore NexHire.sln
dotnet build NexHire.sln --no-restore
```

Expected: Build succeeded. If DLL files are locked, stop any already-running NexHire.API process and build again.

4. Prepare SQL Server LocalDB

```
sqllocaldb info  
sqllocaldb start MSSQLLocalDB
```

The project expects the LocalDB instance MSSQLLocalDB and database NexHireDb.

5. Install / Check EF Core CLI

```
dotnet ef --version
```

Recommended tool version: 8.0.29. If the command is missing:

```
dotnet tool install --global dotnet-ef --version 8.0.29
```

6. Create / Update the Database

```
dotnet ef database update --project src\NexHire.Infrastructure --startup-project src\NexHire.API
```

Expected: migrations apply successfully and the command ends with Done.

7. Configure Registration OTP Email

For a fresh registration, NexHire must send a verification code. Use a Gmail account with a Gmail App Password. Do not put the password inside appsettings.json, the PDF, or GitHub.

```
$env:Email__SmtpHost="smtp.gmail.com"  
$env:Email__SmtpPort="587"  
$env:Email__EnableSsl="true"  
$env:Email__Username="YOUR_SENDER_GMAIL@gmail.com"  
$env:Email__Password="YOUR_GMAIL_APP_PASSWORD"  
$env:Email__FromEmail=$env:Email__Username  
$env:Email__FromName="NexHire"
```

Use a Gmail App Password, not the normal Gmail account password. Keep the real App Password private.

8. Run NexHire

```
dotnet run --project src\NexHire.API --launch-profile http
```

Expected console message: Now listening on: <http://localhost:5119>

9. Verify Runtime

Check	URL	Expected result
API process	http://localhost:5119/health/live	status = live
Database	http://localhost:5119/health/ready	status = ready; database = reachable
NexHire UI	http://localhost:5119/	Redirects to the NexHire login page
Swagger / OpenAPI	http://localhost:5119/swagger	Development API documentation; if Swagger alone has an endpoint-generation issue, use health + root UI to verify application runtime.

10. Login Credentials / First Login

- No fixed credentials are included in the final repository.
- Public registration supports Job Seeker and Employer accounts.
- Open the Register page from the login screen and enter your own email, name and password.
- Password rule: 8-64 characters with uppercase, lowercase, number and symbol.
- NexHire emails a 6-digit OTP. Enter the OTP and verify the email.
- After verification, sign in with the same email and password. The system opens the dashboard for the selected role.
- Administrator is not created through public registration.

11. Visual Studio Method

1. Open NexHire.sln.
2. In Solution Explorer, right-click src/NexHire.API and choose Set as Startup Project.
3. Build the solution.
4. Start with the http profile (F5 or Ctrl+F5).
5. Open <http://localhost:5119/> to use the application UI.

12. Quick Troubleshooting

Problem	Quick fix
dotnet not recognized	Install .NET 8 SDK and reopen the terminal.
dotnet ef not recognized	Install dotnet-ef 8.0.29 globally.
LocalDB / SQL connection error	Install/start MSSQLLocalDB, then rerun database update.
Registration shows unexpected error	Check SMTP environment variables and Gmail App Password; new registration sends email before saving the user.
Build says DLL is locked by NexHire.API	Stop the running API process (Ctrl+C) and build again.
health/live works, health/ready fails	API is running but database is not ready; check LocalDB and migrations.
Login fails on a fresh clone	Fresh DB has no guaranteed fixed user; register and verify a new JobSeeker/Employer first.

13. Minimum Submission Smoke Test

- dotnet restore and dotnet build succeed.
- EF database update succeeds.
- /health/live returns live.
- /health/ready returns database reachable.
- Login/Register page opens.
- Registration email OTP arrives and verifies.
- Verified login opens the correct role dashboard.

Final repository for submission: <https://github.com/Kogulanathan69/SmartRecruitmentMatching-2026->